

## FOLLOW-UP VISITS: ASSESSING ASTHMA CONTROL AND ADJUSTING THERAPY

Level of control (Columns 2–4) is based on the most severe component of impairment (symptoms and functional limitations) or risk (exacerbations). Assess impairment by patient's or caregiver's recall of events listed in Column 1 during the previous 2–4 weeks and by spirometry and/or peak flow measures. Symptom assessment for longer periods should reflect a global assessment, such as inquiring whether the patient's asthma is better or worse since the last visit. Assess risk by recall of exacerbations during the previous year and since the last visit. Recommendations for adjusting therapy based on level of control are presented in the last row.

| Components of Control                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                           | Well Controlled                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                 |                | Not Well Controlled                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                |                | Very Poorly Controlled                                                                                                             |                                               |                |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|----------------|
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                           | Ages 0–4 years                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Ages 5–11 years                                 | Ages ≥12 years | Ages 0–4 years                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Ages 5–11 years                                | Ages ≥12 years | Ages 0–4 years                                                                                                                     | Ages 5–11 years                               | Ages ≥12 years |
| Impairment                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Symptoms                                                                  | ≤2 days/week                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | ≤2 days/week but not more than once on each day | ≤2 days/week   | >2 days/week                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | >2 days/week or multiple times on ≤2 days/week | >2 days/week   | Throughout the day                                                                                                                 |                                               |                |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Nighttime awakenings                                                      | ≤1x/month                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                 | ≤2x/month      | >1x/month                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | ≥2x/month                                      | 1–3x/week      | >1x/week                                                                                                                           | ≥2x/week                                      | ≥4x/week       |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Interference with normal activity                                         | None                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                 |                | Some limitation                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                |                | Extremely limited                                                                                                                  |                                               |                |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | SABA* use for symptom control (not to prevent EIB*)                       | ≤2 days/week                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                 |                | >2 days/week                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                |                | Several times per day                                                                                                              |                                               |                |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Lung function                                                             | Not applicable                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | >80%                                            | >80%           | Not applicable                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 60–80%                                         | 60–80%         | Not applicable                                                                                                                     | <60%                                          | <60%           |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | ➔ FEV <sub>1</sub> * (% predicted) or peak flow (% personal best)         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | >80%                                            | Not applicable |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 75–80%                                         | Not applicable |                                                                                                                                    | <75%                                          | Not applicable |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | ➔ FEV <sub>1</sub> /FVC*                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                 |                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                |                |                                                                                                                                    |                                               |                |
| Validated questionnaires <sup>†</sup>                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                 |                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                |                |                                                                                                                                    |                                               |                |
| Risk                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Asthma exacerbations requiring oral systemic corticosteroids <sup>§</sup> | 0–1/year                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                 |                | 2–3/year                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | ≥2/year                                        |                | >3/year                                                                                                                            | ≥2/year                                       |                |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                           | Consider severity and interval since last asthma exacerbation.                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                 |                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                |                |                                                                                                                                    |                                               |                |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Reduction in lung growth/Progressive loss of lung function                | Not applicable                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Evaluation requires long-term follow-up care.   |                | Not applicable                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Evaluation requires long-term follow-up care.  |                | Not applicable                                                                                                                     | Evaluation requires long-term follow-up care. |                |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Treatment-related adverse effects                                         | Medication side effects can vary in intensity from none to very troublesome and worrisome. The level of intensity does not correlate to specific levels of control but should be considered in the overall assessment of risk. |                                                 |                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                |                |                                                                                                                                    |                                               |                |
| Recommended Action for Treatment<br><br>(See “Stepwise Approach for Managing Asthma Long Term,” page 7)<br><br>The stepwise approach is meant to help, not replace, the clinical decisionmaking needed to meet individual patient needs. |                                                                           | Maintain current step.<br><br>Regular follow-up every 1–6 months.<br><br>Consider step down if well controlled for at least 3 months.                                                                                          |                                                 |                | Step up 1 step                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Step up at least 1 step                        | Step up 1 step | Consider short course of oral systemic corticosteroids.<br><br>Step up 1–2 steps.<br><br>Reevaluate in 2 weeks to achieve control. |                                               |                |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                 |                | Reevaluate in 2–6 weeks to achieve control.<br><br>For children 0–4 years, if no clear benefit observed in 4–6 weeks, consider adjusting therapy or alternative diagnoses.                                                                                        |                                                |                |                                                                                                                                    |                                               |                |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                 |                | Before step up in treatment:<br>Review adherence to medication, inhaler technique, and environmental control. If alternative treatment was used, discontinue and use preferred treatment for that step. For side effects, consider alternative treatment options. |                                                |                |                                                                                                                                    |                                               |                |

\* **Abbreviations:** ACQ, Asthma Control Questionnaire<sup>®</sup>; ACT, Asthma Control Test<sup>™</sup>; ATAQ, Asthma Therapy Assessment Questionnaire<sup>®</sup>; EIB, exercise-induced bronchospasm; FVC, forced vital capacity; FEV<sub>1</sub>, forced expiratory volume in 1 second; SABA, short-acting beta<sub>2</sub>-agonist.

† Minimal important difference: 1.0 for the ATAQ; 0.5 for the ACQ; not determined for the ACT.

‡ ACQ values of 0.76–1.4 are indeterminate regarding well-controlled asthma.

§ Data are insufficient to link frequencies of exacerbations with different levels of asthma control. Generally, more frequent and intense exacerbations (e.g., requiring urgent care, hospital or intensive care admission, and/or oral corticosteroids) indicate poorer asthma control.